JOHANNA ROTH

Website: https://sites.google.com/view/johanna-roth/home
Email: johanna.roth@sciencespo.fr • Phone: + 33 656 68 04 41

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Labor Economics

Secondary: Public and Development Economics

REFERENCES

Professor Pierre Cahuc
Sciences Po
pierre.cahuc@sciencespo.fr

Professor Steven Raphael
University of California, Berkeley
stevenraphael@berkeley.edu

Professor Maria Guadalupe
Insead
maria.guadalupe@insead.edu

Professor Alexandra Roulet
Insead
alexandra.roulet@insead.edu

EDUCATION

2022 – 2026 (expected) **PhD Candidate in Economics, *Sciences Po,* Paris, France**
- PhD advisor: Prof. Pierre Cahuc
- Thesis committee: Prof. Claire Montialoux, Prof. Roland Rathelot (CREST)
- Visiting Student at University of California, Berkeley in Spring 2025
- Research Associate at Insead Stone Center from September 2025 onwards

2020 – 2022 **MPhil Economics, *University of Oxford,* Oxford, United Kingdom**
- Awarded Master of Philosophy with Merit
- Distinction in MPhil Thesis *The Impact of AI on Skill Demand – Evidence from Online Job Vacancies* under the supervision of Prof. Abi Adams-Prassl

2016 – 2019 **BSc Economics, *University of Mannheim,* Mannheim, Germany**
- Awarded Bachelor of Science with Distinction

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE PRIOR PHD

2022 Research Assistant, *Oxford Martin School, University of Oxford*, Oxford, United Kingdom

2021 – 2022 Research Assistant, *Centre for the Study of African Economies, University of Oxford*, Oxford, United Kingdom

2021 Trainee*, European Central Bank, DG Economics, Supply Side, Labour and Surveillance,* Frankfurt, Germany

TEACHING

Fall 2024	**Labor Economics and Employment Policies (Sciences Po Paris, Master)** Teaching Assistant to Prof. Stéphane Carcillo
Spring 2024	**Statistics Advanced (Sciences Po Le Havre, Bachelor)** Lecturer
Fall 2023	**Labor Economics (Sciences Po Paris, Bachelor)** Teaching Assistant to Prof. Moshe Buchinsky
Spring 2023	**Statistics Advanced (Sciences Po Le Havre, Bachelor)** Lecturer

RESEARCH GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Pilot Funding from JPAL European Social Inclusion Initiative (ESII) Round IV (2025-2026, €29K)
- Research Grant from French Ministry of Labor with Alexandra Roulet:
  "APR Évaluation préfigurative de la réforme France Travail" (2024 – 2027, €80K)
- Doctoral School Scholarship, Sciences Po (2022 – 2025)
- Scholarship from Haniel Foundation joint with German Academic Scholarship Foundation (2021 – 2022)
- Scholarship from Konrad-Adenauer-Foundation (2017 – 2022)

WORKING PAPER

The Homelessness Trap: Labor Market Trajectories of Individuals Experiencing Homelessness – *Job Market Paper*

Debates around reducing homelessness point to the role of labor markets in providing an income to afford rent and thus a roof. Yet a rising number of individuals become homeless while working or having recently worked. I study whether job loss causes homelessness and whether homelessness, in turn, raises job separation and lowers job finding. To do so, I link the universe of homeless shelter requests in France to administrative employment records, covering over one million individuals. To identify each direction of the cycle, I use a matched difference-in-differences design around economic layoffs and an instrumental variables design based on the leniency of call-center agents allocating shelter. I find that job loss raises the probability of homelessness by 50 percent over three years, concentrated after unemployment benefits expiry. In the reverse direction, obtaining a shelter bed at the first request reduces the risk of job separation within three months by 17 percent and raises the probability of being employed one year later by 74 percent. Unemployment and homelessness thus reinforce each other, and rapid shelter access breaks this cycle.

Soft-Skills, Unemployment and Job Search (with Maria Guadalupe and Alexandra Roulet)

Non-cognitive skills are increasingly rewarded in labor markets and employers often mention lack of suitable soft skills as a reason for unfilled vacancies. We investigate whether there is a role for public employment services (PES) to intervene to make job seekers' soft skills more in line with employers' expectations. In particular, we evaluate, through a large-scale RCT, a two-week soft skills training program for French job seekers and show that the training improves the relevant skills and enhances job seekers' outcomes, in terms of type of contract, earnings and likelihood to enroll in further training. The training pays for itself for job seekers of more than 50 years old. Our findings highlight the potential of soft skills training in improving job match quality.

Reaching Marginalized Job Seekers through Public Employment Services: Experimental Evidence from Ethiopia, *IZA DP No. 18005* (with Morgan Hardy, Christian Meyer and Marc Witte)

We experimentally evaluate an at-scale expansion of public employment services in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, that provided up-to-date vacancy information through local offices. Benefits were concentrated among relatively lower-skill women (LSW), the most marginalized job seekers before the expansion: offers and wage employment rose, work in household enterprises fell, and earnings increased by 24 percent. Impacts exceeded what the listed vacancies could explain; instead, LSW changed expectations and aspirations. Job match quality also increased. Notably, LSW job offers arrived through friends and family, not through the service directly – evidence that social networks can carry information to those hardest to reach.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Housing or Employment First? Trajectories of Homeless Job Seekers *(RCT awarded JPAL ESII Round IV Pilot Funding) – Currently Pilot in the Field*

Trajectories of Social Minima Benefit Receivers: Predictability and Targeting of Intensive Job Search Counselling Programs (with Alexandra Roulet) – *Currently Pilot in the Field*

Financial Literacy and Well-Being (with Mark Stabile)

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026	Sciences Po internal seminar, Leuven Summer Event, 2nd PhD Conference in Labor and Behavioral Economics, SIOE, Organizational Economics Summer Symposium, EEA, IIPF, EALE, VfS Annual Conference
2025	Berkeley IRLE seminar, IZA 1st PhD Conference in Labor and Behavioral Economics, SOLE – Joint World Labor Conference, European Economic Association (EEA) Conference, Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar, World Bank – KDI 6th Development Impact Conference, Insead Brownbag Seminar
2024	Insead Brownbag Seminar, Jobs and Development Conference, Sciences Po Departmental Seminar, Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD seminar
2023	Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD Seminar
2022	TASKS IV: The Digital and Ecological Transformation of the Labour Market (International BIBB/IAB/ZEW Conference)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Co-organizer of Sciences Po Internal Economics PhD seminar

Referee for *LABOUR: Review of Labour Economics and Industrial Relations*

SKILLS

Programming Languages	STATA, Python, R, SAS.
Languages	German (Native), English (Fluent), French (Fluent)